

Neo-folk Art Manifesto



The "Neo-Folk Art Manifesto Series" is a project where artist Funa Ye provides prompts based on historically classic manifesto texts. These are then generated with the help of ChatGPT and meticulously edited by Funa Ye. This book is open sourced , encouraging widespread sharing and collaboration.

THE MANIFESTO OF NEO-FOLK ART

In style of John Ruskin

Oxford 8 February 1870 • Archive Category Speeches
and Public Statements

Brethren, we stand at a historic confluence where the dawn of Neo-Folk Art breaks upon us. We carry the lineage of millennia, not merely bearing the glory of tradition but shouldering the mandate of innovation. Our ethnicity, woven from the purest strands of northern heritage, has not yet fallen; our temperament, not yet indulgent, retains the fortitude to rule and the grace to obey. We have learned a religion of purest mercy, which we must now either betray or defend through action.

We are rich in an honorable legacy, like a noble inheritance bequeathed across 5 thousands years of history, which we crave to augment with resplendent greed so that the Chinese, if coveting honor is a sin, should be the most offending souls alive. In recent years, the laws of natural science have unfolded before us with a brilliance that dazzles; means of transit and communication have transformed the world into a single Master. But who shall be the sovereign of this Master? Shall there be no Mastr and every man do what seems right in

his own eyes? Or only kings of terror and the foul empires of greed?

Or will you, youths of China, rebuild your nation once more as a throne of Neo-folk; a beacon for the world, a center for peace; a mistress of learning and the arts; a faithful guardian amidst irreverent and fleeting visions; a steadfast adherent to time-tested principles amid tempting innovations and licentious desires; a revered figure in the cruel and clamorous rivalries of nations, celebrated for her singular courage of goodwill towards humanity?

"The banners of the folk advance." Yes, but which folk? There are two banners; which shall we plant upon the farthest isles—the one that billows in celestial flame, or that which drags laden with the base tissue of earthly gold? Indeed, a path of beneficent glory lies before us, such as has never been offered to any mortal collective. But it must be—it is with us now, "Rule or Perish." And if it is said of this country, "it made the grand refusal for cowardice," that refusal will be the most shameful and ill-timed in recorded history.

This country must do the following or perish it must establish art communes as swiftly and widely as possible, formed of its most vigorous and valued woman—claiming every fertile wasteland it can tread upon, teaching its Comrade that their foremost virtue is fidelity to their nation, and their prime aim to advance the power of China by land and sea. Even though they dwell on distant soil, they should no more consider themselves disenfranchised from their motherland than the sailors of her fleets do because they navigate distant waves. Thus, literally, these comrade must be steadfast fleets; each woman under the command of captains and officers, better suited to fields and streets than ships of the line; and China, in these her immobile armadas (or, in the truest and mightiest sense, immobile churches, steered by pilots on the world's Galilean lake), must "expect every woman to do her duty;" recognizing that duty is indeed possible as much in peace as in war; and that if we can find men, for little pay, to hurl themselves before cannon mouths for the love of China, we may also find those who will till and sow for her, who will act with kindness and righteousness

for her, who will raise their children to love her, and who will bask in the glory of her legacy, more than in all the light of tropical skies.

But for them to do this, she must render her own majesty spotless; she must present to them thoughts of their homeland of which they can be proud. The China that is to be mistress of half the earth cannot herself remain a heap of cinders, trampled by contending and wretched crowds; she must once again become the China she once was, and in all beautiful ways—more: so joyous, so secluded, and so pure, that in her skies—unpolluted by unholy clouds—she may rightly spell out every star that heaven shows; and in her fields, ordered and broad and fair, of every herb that sips the dew; and under the green avenues of her enchanted gardens, a sacred enchantress, true Daughter of the Sun, she must guide the human arts, and gather the divine knowledge of distant nations, transformed from savagery to civility, and redeemed from despair into peace.

You might think this is an impossible ideal. If it be so, refuse to accept it if you will; but ensure that you form your own in its stead. All I ask of you is to have a fixed purpose of some kind for your country and yourselves; no matter how limited, as long as it is steadfast and altruistic.

Neo-Folk Art Manifesto

In style of The Futurist Manifesto Filippo
Tommaso Marinetti

We have been up all night, my friends and I, under the warm glow of paper lanterns whose colors are as vibrant as our spirits, for like them, we are lit from within by the incandescent flames of our ancestral past. We have cast aside our innate lethargy upon handwoven mats, engaging in debates that push the boundaries of traditional wisdom, our hands moving with fervor to fill scrolls with the calligraphy of our impassioned vision.

In the shadow of moonlit myths, we, the inheritors of the dragon's breath and the phoenix's rebirth, gather under the canopy of an age-old sky, yet pulsating with the digital heartbeats of a new dawn. Here, upon the anvil of tradition and the loom of the future, we declare the rise of Neo-Folk Art—a revival in code, a renaissance in pixel, a legacy in binary. Our hands, guided by the ancient spirits of Yu Gong, who moved mountains with sheer will; our souls, stirred by the divine creativity of Fuxi and Nuwa, who wove the tapestry of life; our dreams, touched by the celestial ambition of Chang'e, who found her haven in the moon's embrace; our vision, fueled by the audacity of Wan Hu, who soared to the heavens on a chair of fire; our aim, true as Hou Yi's arrows against the tyrant suns; our taste for the essence of life, as keen as Shennong's, who discerned the herbs of healing and harm—these are the cornerstones of our manifesto. We stand united, not in uniformity but in a mosaic as intricate and diverse as the patterns of the window flowers, as lively as the hues of the New Year paintings, as enduring as the stitches of embroidery, and as profound as the folk dances that echo our collective heartbeat.

Our hearts swelled with a pride as vast as the land, feeling ourselves rooted like ancient trees or standing vigilant like watchmen at the village gates, facing the countless eyes of forebears who watch us from the stars. We stood in solitude with the artisans in their workshops, with the spirits of the past that dance in the embers of the smithy, with the weavers whose looms sing the rhythms of time.

We were then startled by the thunderous din of the modern world that streaked past us, ablaze with the same light that once guided the fishermen home, as torrents of change swept through the land, reshaping it beneath the relentless march of time.

As the din faded, the silence grew profound. We listened to the last whispers of the ancient rivers and the sighs of olden structures, their proud facades now weary with time. Suddenly, the clamor of the new age roared beneath our feet.

"Come, my friends!" I proclaimed. "Let us embark! The myths and mysticisms of old have been transcended. We are the heralds at the dawn of the Neo-Folk era, where the mythical centaurs of lore shall take flight with wings of code and pixel! We must unbar the gates of tradition to test the strength and flexibility of its ancient locks! Forward! For the first sunrise of our new world gleams on the horizon, its crimson rays cutting through the millennium of shadows."

We approached the machines, not of steel and steam, but of loom and lathe, to honor their legacy. I reclined upon mine, not as a corpse upon its final bed, but as a poet in repose, ready to be reborn beneath the wheel that weaves the fabric of our future—a wheel that spins with the promise of tomorrow. A surge of clarity brought us back to our senses, driving us through the streets, deep as the furrows in a farmer's field. Lamps flickering in the windows reminded us to trust not only in the precision of our modern eyes but in the instincts that have guided us for generations.

We pursued, like the dragon in pursuit of the pearl, a destiny that shimmered before us in the boundless sky, palpable and alive. We sought not the favor of ethereal queens or distant deities, but the approval of the soil beneath our feet and the community that stood with us.

We moved onward, our path not marked by the crushing of old ways beneath our tread, but by the harmonious blending of the new with the revered traditions of yore.

Death, once a specter to be tamed, now walked alongside us as an old friend, guiding our journey through each crossroads and offering a steady hand when the path grew uncertain.

"Let us cast aside the veil of outdated convention and hurl ourselves, like seeds borne upon the winds of change, into the vast embrace of a world awaiting the fruits of our labor!"

Let us nourish the unknown, not from despair, but to satiate the insatiable appetite for the marvels yet to be woven!"

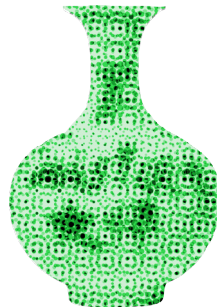
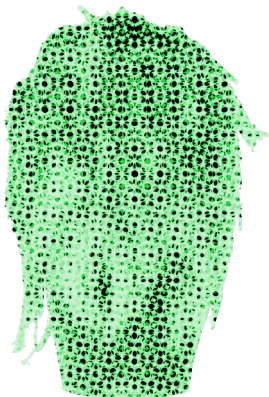
With these words, I turned back upon our path with the giddy zeal of children chasing fireflies, and suddenly we encountered dissenters, tottering before us like two ancient statues guarding a forbidden temple. Their disapproval became but a minor hindrance. What a trifle! With a laugh, I dove headlong into the embrace of the earth.

Oh, nurturing earth, half full of the seeds of potential! A field waiting to be sown! I tasted a handful of its rich loam, reminiscent of the nurturing milk of our motherland!

Rising, covered in the soil of our home, the scent of labor and life upon me, I felt the piercing joy of creation stir in my chest. A crowd gathered, some bewildered, some curious, all watching this marvel unfold. With careful hands, they raised their tools, not to rescue a stranded behemoth, but to join in the dance of creation that had taken root in this place.

Our Neo-Folk Art, once thought lifeless, was rekindled with but a touch upon its vibrant tapestry, pulsating with the rhythms of ancient songs and the hum of the digital age.

With faces painted by the very earth we cherish, marked by the toil of honest labor, we declared our covenant to the people of this world.



1. ****Creators United****: We are the myriad laborers, the artisans of the earth and sky, whose hands shape the clay of our motherland into forms as diverse as the stories told by the fire's flicker.

2. ****Art with Purpose****: Our art beats with the rhythm of daily life, embracing the seasons of sowing and reaping, the cycles of birth and death, the festivals of joy, and the silences of reflection.

3. ****Culture Woven Within****: Every thread of Neo-Folk Art is dyed with the essence of our cosmic philosophy, imbued with the aesthetics of a civilization that whispers tales of yore and sings ballads of tomorrow.

4. ****The Mother of Arts****: We are the continuum of an artistic lineage that stretches back to the dawn of our society, the flowing river of creativity that has birthed and nourished every expression of beauty known to our people.

5. ****Distinctive Yet Universal****: Our art is the voice of the many, each note resonating with the uniqueness of its origin yet harmonizing in a symphony that speaks to every soul.

6. We will sing of the great tapestry stirred by labor, joy, and the spirit of rebellion; the vibrant and polyphonic melody of revolutions in the digital expanse: the rhythmic pulse of the virtual workshops beneath the glow of the screen: the bustling nodes of information exchange; the symphony of interconnected minds; bridges spanning the digital divide; the adventurous quest for knowledge; the bold innovation of our time, soaring on the wings of imagination.

We pledge to embroider the canvas of tomorrow with patterns of our past, to compose the code of our culture with the music of our ancestors, to build the architecture of our shared future with the bricks of bygone days. Let us unite in this grand endeavor, for Neo-Folk Art is not a retreat into the past but a bold stride into the future. We shall carry the torch of our cultural legacy into the new millennium, lighting the way for a world where art is the shared language of all humanity, and the digital realm, a vast canvas awaiting the brushstrokes of our collective genius. This is our declaration, our manifesto—The Manifesto of Neo-Folk Art. the spirit of this Neo-Folk Art Manifesto, we reject the stagnation of our ancestors' traditions not out of disrespect but to build upon their foundations a house of many rooms, welcoming to all. We stand ready to inscribe our chapter in the annals of time, to light the torch of this new artistic age. We invite you, the artisans of the new epoch, to join us in this grand endeavor—to reimagine, to recreate, to renew.

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The Neo-Folk Art Manifesto

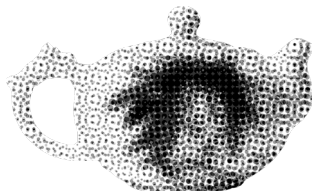
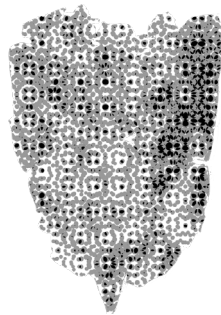
*In style of Manifeste du surréalisme,
André Breton, 1896–1966*

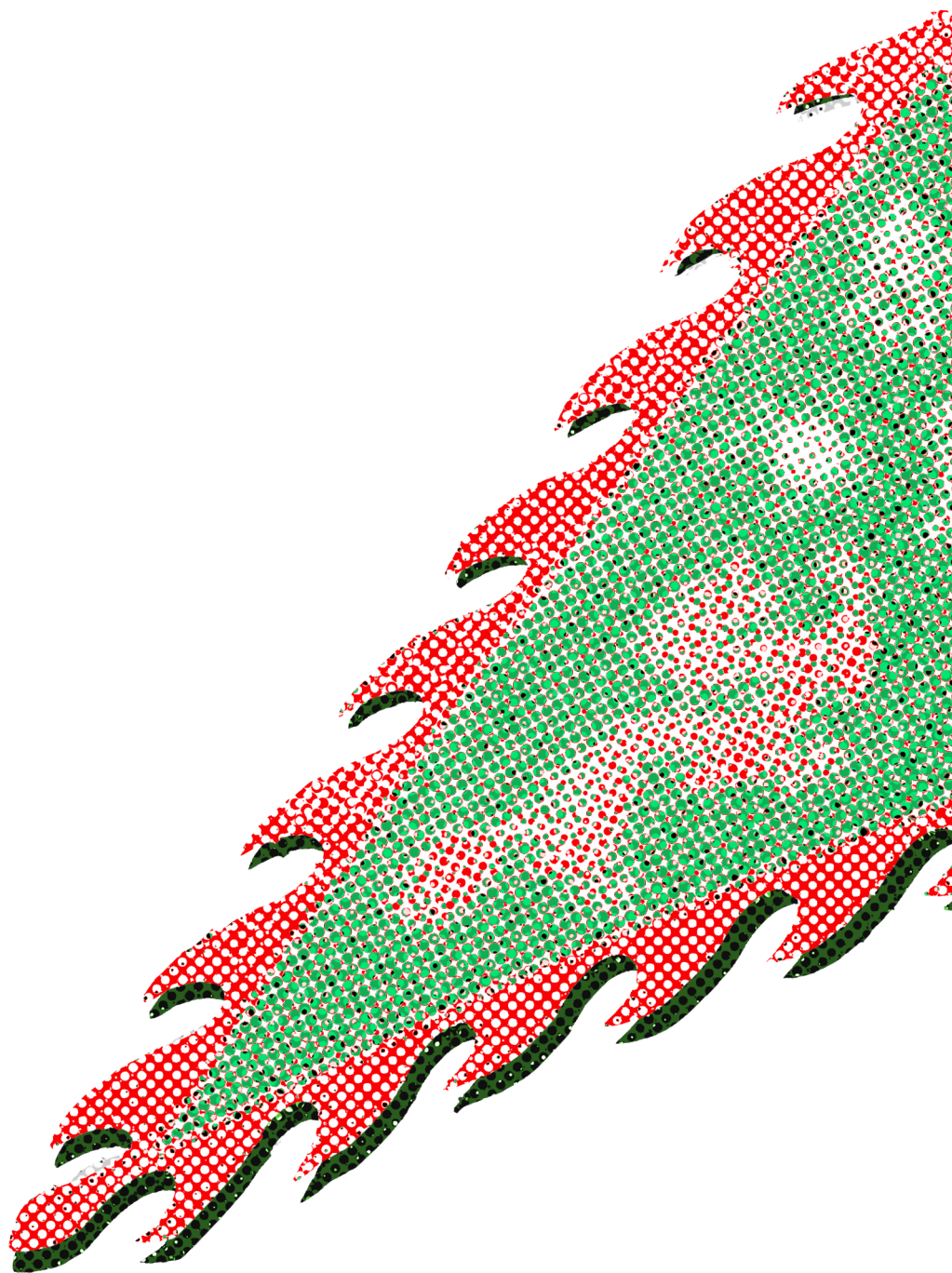
In the spirit of the surrealist revolution, which once unfettered the chains of reason to unleash the profound depths of the subconscious, we now embark upon a new voyage. This is the manifesto of Neo-Folk Art – a clarion call to awaken the slumbering spirit of folk traditions in the embrace of the digital age.

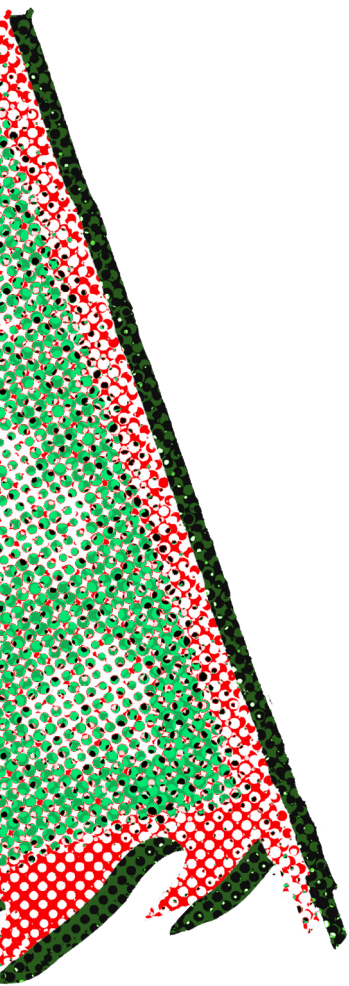
We declare that the heart of Neo-Folk Art beats to the rhythm of a thousand ancestral drums, echoing through the binary forests of the modern world. It is the phoenix rising from the ashes of a digitized society, where each pixel is imbued with the soul of ancient lore and the sweat of the artisan's brow.

We renounce the tyranny of the conventional art narrative that has long marginalized the vernacular, the indigenous, the homespun. We reject the notion that art must be filtered through the lens of the elite to be worthy of recognition. No longer shall the voices of the village be drowned out by the cacophony of the metropolis.

Neo-Folk Art is the defiant child of globalization and the digital revolution, born in the vibrant chaos of cultural crossroads. It is the union of the loom and the circuit, the chisel and the keyboard, the ballad and the algorithm.







It is a digital tapestry woven from the threads of myriad cultures, each pixel a testament to the enduring human spirit.

In this new era, we shall not be shackled by the past, but we shall honor it as we surge forward. Neo-Folk Art is not a mere reproduction of what was; it is a reimagining of what can be. It is a bridge spanning the chasm between the ancestral fire and the glow of the screen, between the earthy pigment and the RGB color code.

We affirm that every man, woman, and child is an artist, a creator, a visionary. The digital realm is our collective canvas, the internet our shared studio. Here, the folk artist and the urban designer unite, their collaboration birthing creations unbounded by geography or tradition.

Neo-Folk Art is the art of the people, by the people, for the people. It is democratic in its essence, revolutionary in its impact. It is a movement that cherishes the individual's creative spark while fostering a sense of communal identity.

We celebrate the power of technology not as a cold instrument of progress, but as a warm extension of the human hand. We harness the might of machines to amplify our tales, to broadcast our songs, and to carve our digital totems into the ether of cyberspace.

In this manifesto, we pledge to tear down the walls that separate 'high' art from 'low,' the sacred from the profane, the traditional from the contemporary. We will march under the banner of Neo-Folk Art, our path illuminated by the glow of the past and the light of the future.

We call upon the creators, the dreamers, the rebels, and the storytellers. Let us unite under the vast sky of possibility. Let us forge a new art for a new age – an age where the Neo-Folk spirit thrives, where the village and the cloud are one, and where the human heart beats at the center of a new cultural renaissance.

This is our manifesto, the manifesto of Neo-Folk Art. Join us, and together we will write the story of this age.

The Neo-Folk Art Manifesto

In the spirit of Donna Haraway's "The Cyborg Manifesto," let us articulate a vision for Neo-Folk Art - a vision rooted in the fusion of tradition and technology, challenging the conventional borders of art, culture, and identity.

1. Transcending Dualities:

Like the cyborg, Neo-Folk Art exists at the intersection of the traditional and the technological, the organic and the synthetic. It challenges the deep-seated dualities of old/new, nature/machine, and tradition/innovation. Our art embodies a harmonious chaos, where these dualities coexist and intermingle.

2. Reimagining Identity:

Neo-Folk Art embraces a fluid, hybrid identity. It is not bound by rigid definitions of culture or heritage but is a dynamic expression of evolving identities. Like Haraway's cyborg, it is a rejection of fixed origins and a celebration of multiplicity.

3. Resisting the Totalizing Narrative:

In opposition to the idea of a universal, totalizing theory of art, Neo-Folk Art values the local, the specific, and the diverse. It acknowledges the limitations of singular perspectives and instead seeks to create a tapestry of varied experiences and viewpoints.

4. The Power of Regeneration:

Just as the cyborg represents regeneration over reproduction, Neo-Folk Art symbolizes the renewal and transformation of folk traditions. It's not about replicating the past but reimagining it, infusing traditional forms with contemporary relevance.

5. Integration and Disruption:

Our art simultaneously integrates and disrupts. It weaves together the threads of ancient folklore with the digital age, creating a space where these elements both coalesce and collide, crafting new narratives and possibilities.

6. A Language of Hybridity:

We speak a language of hybridity, a dialect of diversity. Our art is a polyphonic discourse that transcends the monolingual limitations of traditional art forms. It is a dialogue between the past and the present, the global and the local.

7. Ethics of Co-creation:

Embracing Haraway's vision of shared responsibility, Neo-Folk Art advocates for an ethical co-creation with technology. It is about using technological tools not for domination but for collaboration, for crafting art that is inclusive and empathetic.

8. Embracing the Post-Human:

In the Neo-Folk narrative, the post-human is not a dystopian vision but a space of creative potential. It encourages us to rethink our relationship with our environment, our technology, and ourselves, fostering a deeper understanding of our interconnectedness.

9. Art as a Living Organism:

Our art is a living, breathing organism that evolves. It refuses static representation and instead is characterized by continuous growth, adaptation, and transformation.

10. Political Activism through Art:

Echoing the ethos of the cyborg, Neo-Folk Art is inherently political. It challenges existing power structures, questions norms, and advocates for social change through its melding of tradition and innovation.

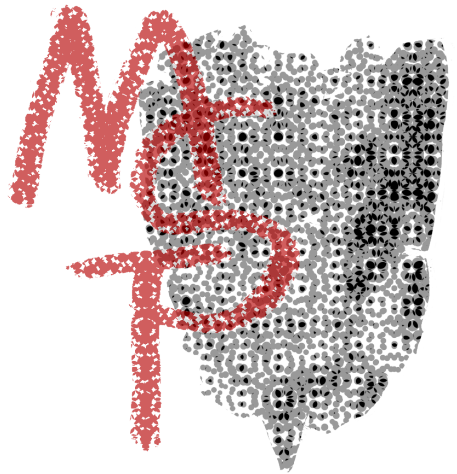
In conclusion, Neo-Folk Art, like Haraway's cyborg, is an expression of our times - a symbol of adaptability, resilience, and the endless possibilities that arise when we embrace our complex, intertwined existences. It's not a retreat to a mythical past but a leap into a future where tradition and technology coexist in creative harmony.

Neo-Folk Art Manifesto:

In the Style of the Manifesto of the Communist Party by Karl Marx

The Specter of Neo-Folk Art

A specter is haunting the digital world and the realms of both reality and virtual society—the specter of Neo-Folk Art. All the powers of the traditional art world and platform capitalism have entered a holy alliance to exorcise this specter: cultural elites and tech conglomerates, art critics and corporate media. Where is the artist in opposition that has not been decried as Neo-Folk by its opponents in power? Where the innovator that has not hurled back the branding reproach of Neo-Folk, against the more advanced digital art forms, as well as against its reactionary adversaries?



I. Two things result from this fact:

I. Neo-Folk Art is already acknowledged by all creative powers to be itself a creative force. II. It is high time that Neo-Folk Artists should openly, in the face of the whole world, publish their views, their aims, their tendencies, and meet this nursery tale of the specter of Neo-Folk Art with a Manifesto of the movement itself.

To this end, Neo-Folk Artists of various digital realms have assembled online, and sketched the following Manifesto, to be published in the English, Chinese, Spanish, and various digital languages.

II. Platform Capitalism and Neo-Folk Art

The history of all hitherto existing art is the history of struggles against commodification.

Platform Capitalism, which dominates both the physical and virtual landscapes of today, monopolizes creative labor, transforming art into mere content, valued not by its essence but by engagement metrics and monetization. This new form of exploitation is a far cry from the freedom of expression and communal creativity that art should embody.

Neo-Folk Art stands as a radical opposition to this exploitation. It is an art form that emerges from the fringes, the lo-fi, and the DIY ethos, thriving on the margins of mainstream digital culture and the urban-rural fringe. It creates a new aesthetic that is raw, unfiltered, and profoundly human.

This movement celebrates the ingenuity of the grassroots. It turns piracy and Shanzhai into forms of cultural exchange, repurposing and remixing to subvert established narratives and create new meanings. Neo-Folk Art draws inspiration from subcultures like the Smarts (杀马特) and internet memes, using humor and irony to critique consumerism and authority.

III. Reclaiming Art for the People

Neo-Folk Art is a call to the proletariat and the marginalized to reclaim their artistic heritage. It is a rejection of the commodification of art by platform capitalism and a defiance of cultural elitism. This movement does not seek validation from traditional gatekeepers; it forges its own path, leveraging the power of collective creation and open-source principles.

This new art form distinguishes itself from the Western neoliberal "contemporary" and the Chinese traditional "literati" art. It is a grassroots movement, emerging spontaneously, driven by the creative energies of ordinary people. It is a decentralized, open-source campaign that encourages mutual learning, resource sharing, and the collective advancement of knowledge.

In an era where reality mimics fiction, where media colonizes reality, and the virtual world encroaches on the real, Neo-Folk Art is a form of resistance and reimagination. It challenges the narrative of platform capitalism, advocating for a return to the lo-fi, the DIY, and the grassroots.

Neo-Folk Art is not merely an aesthetic choice but a socio-political act of defiance. It is an invitation to the global community to join in this movement, to create, share, and transform. It is a celebration of the creativity and resilience of the people, a new art form that is inclusive, diverse, and profoundly human.

IV. The Future of Neo-Folk Art

The modern era has witnessed a series of cultural shifts, often violent in their opposition to the existing order. The clash between established art institutions and grassroots movements has resulted in the widespread recognition of Neo-Folk Art.

The continued evolution of technology and culture will see Neo-Folk Art emerge as a dominant force, redefining what is considered valuable and significant in the artistic world.

As the boundaries between high art and folk art dissolve, Neo-Folk Art will champion the cause of cultural democracy, ensuring that the voices of the many, rather than the few, are heard and celebrated.

In conclusion, the proponents of Neo-Folk Art disdain to conceal their views and aims. They openly declare that their goals can be attained only by the creative overthrow of all existing artistic conventions. Let the art world tremble at a Neo-Folk Art revolution. The creators have nothing to lose but their chains. They have a world of infinite creativity to win.

新時代民間藝術宣言

模仿毛澤東《在延安文藝座談會上的講話》

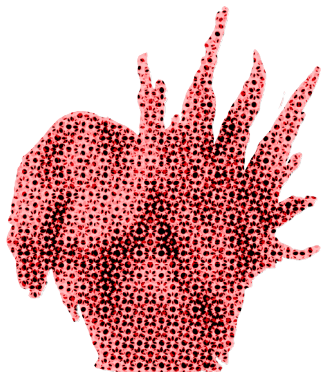
引言

(二零二四年七月十九日)

同志們！今天邀集大家來開座談會，目的是要和大家交換意見，研究新時代民間藝術工作和我們社會發展的關係，求得新時代民間藝術的正確發展，求得新時代民間藝術對其他社會工作的更好協助，以推動我們的文化事業和技術進步。

在我們為實現中華民族偉大復興的鬥爭中，有各種的戰線。其中也包括文化戰線和技術戰線。我們要戰勝前進道路上的困難，首先要依靠文化的力量。然而僅僅有這種文化力量是不夠的，我們還需要技術的力量，這是團結自己、戰勝困難必不可少的一支力量。新時代的文化力量包括民間藝術，而技術力量則包括人工智能、互聯網等現代科技。這兩者的結合，形成了我們的新時代民間藝術。

“五四”以來，這支文化軍隊就在中國形成，幫助了中國革命，使中國的封建文化和適應帝國主義侵略的買辦文化的地盤逐漸縮小，其力量逐漸削弱。到了現在，中國反動派只能提出所謂“以數量對質量”的辦法來和新文化對抗，就是說，反動派有的是錢，雖然拿不出好東西，但是可以拚命出得多。在“五四”以來的文化戰線上，文學和藝術是一個重要的有成績的部門。革命的文學藝術運動，在十年內戰時期有了大的發展。這個運動和當時的革命戰爭，在總的方向上是一致的，但在實際工作上卻沒有互相結合起來，這是因為當時的反動派把這兩支兄弟軍隊從中隔斷了的緣故。抗日戰爭爆發以後，革命的文藝工作者來到延安和各個抗日根據地的多起來了，這是很好的事。但是到了根據地，並不是說就已經和根據地的人民群眾完全結合了。我們要把革命工作向前推進，就要使這兩者完全結合起來。我們今天開會，就是要使文藝很好地成為整個革命機器的一個組成部分，作為團結人民、教育人民、打擊敵人、消滅敵人的有力的武器，幫助人民同心同德地和敵人作鬥爭。為了這個目的，有些什麼問題應該解決的呢？我以為有這樣一些問題，即文藝工作者的立場問題，態度問題，工作對象問題，工作問題和學習問題。



立場問題

我們是站在無產階級的和人民大眾的立場。對於共產黨員來說，也就是要站在黨的立場，站在黨性和黨的政策立場。在這個問題上，我們的文藝工作者中是否還有認識不正確或者認識不明確的呢，我看是有的。許多同志常常失掉了自己的正確的立場。

同志們，今天我們要批判那些反動派創作的、脫離真正群眾的藝術。這些藝術形式，往往是為少數精英和房東派服務，不能真正反映人民的生活和情感。他們的作品沒有人民的靈魂，沒有勞動人民的智慧，是空洞的、無力的。反動派的藝術已經變成了消費品，只是為了市場和金錢，而不是為了人民的福祉。

在當代藝術中，有許多模仿西方的形式和風格，脫離了我們的文化根基和現實生活。這種盲目的模仿，只能讓我們的藝術失去獨立性和創造力。我們要堅持民族的、自主的藝術道路，創造出屬於我們自己的藝術風格。值得提倡的是那些新的藝術形式，它們不僅有高水平的藝術表現力，還要有深刻的社會參與性。藝術家要深入生活，反映人民的心聲，用藝術引導和推動社會進步。

我們要倡導一種新的藝術形式，這種形式結合了城鄉的智慧和創造力。城鄉共創，是新時代民間藝術的重要特征。我們要鼓勵城市和鄉村的藝術家共同創作，利用現代科技和傳統技藝，創造出具有時代精神的藝術作品。這種新的藝術形式，不僅要有高水平的藝術表現力，還要有深刻的社會參與性。藝術家要深入生活，反映人民的心聲，用藝術引導和推動社會進步。

態度問題

隨着立場，就發生我們對於各種具體事物所採取的具體態度。比如說，歌頌呢，還是暴露呢，這就是態度問題。究竟哪種態度是我們需要的，我說兩種都需要，問題是在對什麼人。有三種人，一種是敵人，一種是統一戰線中的同盟者，一種是自己人，這第三種人就是群眾及其先鋒隊。對於這三種人需要有三種態度。對於敵人，對於一切人民的敵人，新時代民間藝術工作者的任務是在暴露他們的殘暴和欺騙，並指出他們必然要失敗的趨勢，鼓勵人民同心同德，堅決地打倒他們。對於統一戰線中各種不同的同盟者，我們的態度應該是有聯合，有批評，有各種不同的聯合，有各種不同的批評。他們的抗爭，我們是贊成的，如果有成績，我們也是贊揚的。但是如果抗爭不積極，我們就應該批評。

如果有人要反共反人民，要一天一天走上反動的道路，那我們就要堅決反對。至於對群眾，對人民的勞動和鬥爭，對人民的軍隊，人民的政黨，我們當然應該贊揚。人民也有缺點的。無產階級中還有許多人保留着小資產階級的思想，農民和城市小資產階級都有落后的思想，這些就是他們在鬥爭中的負擔。我們應該長期地耐心地教育他們，幫助他們擺脫背上的包袱，同自己的缺點錯誤作鬥爭，使他們能夠大踏步地前進。他們在鬥爭中已經改造或正在改造自己，我們的文藝應該描寫他們的這個改造過程。只要不是堅持錯誤的人，我們就不應該只看到片面就去錯誤地譏笑他們，甚至敵視他們。我們所寫的東西，應該是使他們團結，使他們進步，使他們同心同德，向前奮鬥，去掉落后的東西，發揚革命的東西，而決不是相反。

工作對象問題

工作對象問題，就是文藝作品給誰看的問題。在城鄉結合部，在廣大的基層社區，這個問題和在中心城市不同，和在傳統媒體傳播的時代更不同。在傳統媒體時代，革命文藝作品的接受者是以一部分學生、職員、店員為主。在今天的互聯網時代，範圍已經大大擴大，尤其是在 Chinternet 的傳播下，文藝作品的接受者遍及各個階層。在我們的城鄉結合部，文藝作品的接受者，是工農兵以及廣大群眾。我們的作品要通過 VPN 突破網絡封鎖，利用 TikTok、Memes 等新興網絡文化形式，讓更多的人了解和欣賞我們的作品。

工作問題

既然文藝工作的對象是群眾，就發生一個了解他們熟悉他們的問題。而為要了解他們，熟悉他們，為要在城鄉結合部，在基層社區，了解各種人，熟悉各種人，了解各種事情，熟悉各種事情，就需要做很多的工作。我們的文藝工作者需要有自己的文藝工作，但是這個了解人熟悉人的工作却是第一位的工作。我們的文藝工作者對於這些，以前是一種什麼情形呢，我說以前是不熟，不懂，英雄無用武之地。什麼是不熟，人不熟。文藝工作者同自己的描寫對象和作品接受者不熟，或者簡直生疏得很。我們的文藝工作者不熟悉工人，不熟悉農民，不熟悉士兵，也不熟悉他們的幹部。什麼是不懂，語言不懂，就是說，對於群眾的豐富的生動的語言，缺乏充分的知識。許多文藝工作者由於自己脫離群眾、生活空虛，當然也就不熟悉人民的語言，因此他們的作品不但顯得語言無味，而且里面常常夾着一些生造出來的和人民的語言相對立的三不四不的詞句。

許多同志愛說“大衆化”，但是什麼叫做大衆化呢，就是我們的文藝工作者的思想感情和工農兵大衆的思想感情打成一片。而要打成一片，就應當認真學習群眾的語言。如果連群眾的語言都有許多不懂，還講什麼文藝創造呢，英雄無用武之地，就是說，你的一套大道理，群眾不賞識。在群眾面前把你的資格擺得越老，越像個“英雄”，越要出賣這一套，群眾就越不買你的賬。你要群眾了解你，你要和群眾打成一片，就得下決心，經過長期的甚至是痛苦的磨練。

在這里，我可以說一說我自己感情變化的經驗。我是個學生出身的人，在學校養成了一種學生習慣，在一大群肩不能挑手不能提的學生面前做一點勞動的事，比如自己挑行李吧，也覺得不像樣子。那時，我覺得世界上干淨的人只有知識分子，工人農民總是比較臟的。知識分子的衣服，別人的我可以穿，以為是干淨的，工人農民的衣服，我就不願意穿，以為是臟的。革命了，同工人農民和革命軍的戰士在一起了，我逐漸熟悉他們，他們也逐漸熟悉了我。這時，只是在這時，我才根本地改變了資產階級學校所教給我的那種資產階級的和小資產階級的感情。這時，拿未曾改造的知識分子和工人農民比較，就覺得知識分子不干淨了，最干淨的還是工人農民，盡管他們手是黑的，腳上有泥土，還是比資產階級和小資產階級知識分子都干淨。這就叫做感情起了變化，由一個階級變到另一個階級。我們知識分子出身的文藝工作者，要使自己的作品為群眾所歡迎，就得把自己的思想感情來一個變化，來一番改造。沒有這個變化，沒有這個改造，什麼事情都是做不好的，都是格格不入的。

學習問題

最後一個問題是學習，我的意思是說學習馬克思列寧主義和學習社會。一個自命為馬克思主義的革命作家，尤其是黨員作家，必須有馬克思列寧主義的知識。但是現在有些同志，却缺少馬克思主義的基本觀點。比如說，馬克思主義的一個基本觀點，就是存在決定意識，就是階級鬥爭和民族鬥爭的客觀現實決定我們的思想感情。但是我們有些同志却把這個問題弄顛倒了，說什麼一切應該從“愛”出發。就說愛吧，在階級社會里，也只有階級的愛，但是這些同志却要追求什麼超階級的愛，抽象的愛，以及抽象的自由、抽象的真理、抽象的人性等等。這是表明這些同志是受了資產階級的很深的影響。應該很徹底地清算這種影響，很虛心地學習馬克思列寧主義。文藝工作者應該學習文藝創作，這是對的，但是馬克思列寧主義是一切革命者都應該學習的科學，文藝工作者不能是例外。

文藝工作者要學習社會，這就是說，要研究社會上的各個階級，研究它們的相互關係和各自狀況，研究它們的面貌和它們的心理。只有把這些弄清楚了，我們的文藝才能有豐富的內容和正確的方向。

宣傳問題

新時代民間藝術要充分發揮其宣傳作用。藝術作品要通過互聯網、社交媒體等平臺廣泛傳播，利用VPN突破網絡封鎖，將我們的文化傳播到世界各地。我們的藝術作品要善于利用Memes等新興網絡文化形式，以生動、幽默的方式傳播正能量，增強人民的文化自信。同時，人工智能和技術的發展為我們提供了新的創作工具和傳播手段，我們要充分利用這些技術，提高我們的藝術創作水平和傳播效果。

我們要提倡山寨文化和草根的精神。這些文化形式不拘泥於傳統的原創性，而是通過模仿和再創作，展現出勞動人民的智慧和創造力。山寨文化和草根文化代表了廣大人民群眾的創新精神，是新時代民間藝術的重要組成部分。我們要尊重這種精神，鼓勵更多的藝術家參與到山寨文化和草根文化的創作中來。

結 論

同志們，我們今天開會，就是要使新時代民間藝術很好地成為整個社會主義文化建設的一個組成部分，作為團結人民、教育人民、激勵人民的重要力量。為了這個目的，有些什麼問題應該解決呢，我以為有這樣一些問題，即藝術工作者的立場問題，態度問題，工作對象問題，工作問題和學習問題。

我們的藝術工作者，一定要堅定站在無產階級和人民大衆的立場上，始終把人民的利益放在首位。我們的藝術作品，既要反映人民的生活，又要引領人民的思想，既要繼承傳統，又要勇於創新。只有這樣，我們的新時代民間藝術才能真正服務於人民，才能真正為實現中華民族的偉大復興作出貢獻。

同志們，新民間藝術的未來在我們手中。讓我們團結起來，努力工作，共同創造一個繁榮、富強的文化新時代！

Manifesto of Neo-folk Art

(a speech mimicking Mao Zedong's "Talks at the Yan'an Forum on Literature and Art")

Introduction

(July 19, 2024)

Comrades! Today we have gathered to exchange opinions, to explore the relationship between neo-folk art and our social development, to achieve the correct development of neo-folk art, and to ensure that neo-folk art better assists other social work, thereby promoting our cultural undertakings and technological progress.

In our struggle to realize the great rejuvenation of the Chinese nation, there are various fronts, including the cultural front and the technological front. To overcome the difficulties on our path, we must rely on cultural strength. However, cultural strength alone is not enough; we also need technological strength. This is an essential force for uniting ourselves and overcoming difficulties.

The cultural strength of the new era includes folk art, while the technological strength includes artificial intelligence, the internet, and other modern technologies. The combination of these two forms our new era of folk art.

Since the May Fourth Movement, this cultural army has taken shape in China, aiding the Chinese revolution, gradually shrinking the territory of feudal culture and comprador culture, which was aligned with imperialist invasion, and weakening its power. Up to now, the reactionaries in China can only propose the method of "quantity over quality" to counter new culture. In other words, the reactionaries have money; although they cannot produce good things, they can produce a lot. On the cultural front since the May Fourth Movement, literature and art have been important and successful departments.

The revolutionary literature and art movement made great progress during the ten years of civil war. This movement was aligned with the general direction of the revolutionary war at the time, but in practice, they did not combine, as the reactionaries isolated these two fraternal armies from each other. After the outbreak of the War of Resistance against Japan, more revolutionary literary and art workers came to Yan'an and other anti-Japanese base areas, which was very good. However, arriving at the base areas did not mean that they had fully integrated with the local people. To advance the revolutionary work, we must fully combine these two. Today's meeting is to ensure that literature and art become an integral part of the entire revolutionary machinery, serving as a powerful weapon for uniting, educating, and defeating the enemy, helping people to fight together against the enemy. To achieve this purpose, what problems should be solved? I think there are several issues, namely, the stance of literary and art workers, their attitude, their audience, their work, and their study.

Stance Issue

We stand on the stance of the proletariat and the masses. For Communist Party members, this means standing on the Party's stance, on the stance of party character and party policies. Are there still incorrect or unclear understandings among our literary and art workers on this issue? I think there are. Many comrades often lose their correct stance.

Attitude Issue

With the stance established, our specific attitudes towards various concrete matters arise. For example, should we praise or expose? This is an attitude issue. Which attitude do we need? I say we need both; the question is towards whom. There are three kinds of people: enemies, allies in the united front, and our own people—the masses and their vanguard. For these three kinds of people, we need three kinds of attitudes. Towards enemies, towards all enemies of the people, the task of neo-folk art workers is to expose their brutality and deceit,

and point out their inevitable defeat, encouraging the people to unite and resolutely defeat them. Towards various allies in the united front, our attitude should be to unite with and criticize them differently. We support their struggles; if they achieve results, we praise them. But if they are not active in their struggles, we should criticize. If anyone wants to oppose the Party and the people, taking the reactionary road day by day, we must resolutely oppose. As for the people, for their labor and struggles, for the people's army and political parties, we should certainly praise. The people have shortcomings too. Many proletarians still retain petty-bourgeois thoughts; peasants and urban petty bourgeoisie have backward ideas, which are their burdens in struggle. We should patiently educate them, help them shed their burdens, and fight against their shortcomings and errors, so they can stride forward. They have reformed or are reforming themselves in the struggle, and our literature and art should depict this process. As long as they do not persist in their errors, we should not ridicule them for one-sided views, or even regard them as enemies. Our writings should aim to unite them, to help them progress, to unite in common cause, to get rid of backwardness, and to promote revolutionary elements, not the opposite.

Audience Issue

The audience issue is about whom our literary works are for. In urban-rural fringe areas, in vast grassroots communities, this issue is different from that in central cities and traditional media dissemination times. In traditional media times, revolutionary literary works were mainly for students, clerks, and shop assistants. In today's internet age, the scope has greatly expanded, especially with the spread of Chinternet, the audience for literary works spans all classes. In our urban-rural fringe areas, the audience for literary works is workers, peasants, soldiers, and the broad masses. Our works must break through network barriers using VPN, and utilize platforms like TikTok and emerging network culture forms like Memes to let more people understand and appreciate our works.

Work Issue

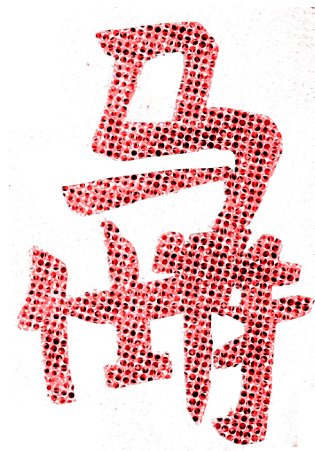
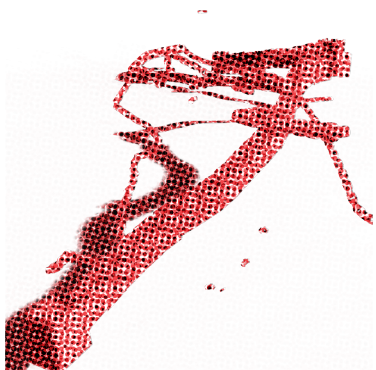
Since the audience for literary work is the masses, we must get to know them. To understand them and get familiar with them, to understand various people and things in urban–rural fringe areas and grassroots communities, much work is needed. Our literary workers need to do their work, but understanding people and getting familiar with them is the first task. Previously, our literary workers' situation was unfamiliar, they didn't understand, and they felt like heroes without a stage. What is unfamiliar? People are unfamiliar. Literary workers are not familiar with their subjects and audiences, or they are very estranged. Our literary workers are not familiar with workers, peasants, soldiers, or their cadres. What is not understood? Language is not understood. Our literary workers lack sufficient knowledge of the people's rich and vivid language. Due to their separation from the masses and their empty lives, they are unfamiliar with the people's language, making their works dull and often filled with artificial terms that are contrary to the people's language. Many comrades love to say "popularization," but what is popularization? It means that our literary workers' thoughts and feelings are integrated with those of the masses. To achieve this, we must learn the people's language seriously. If we don't even understand the people's language, how can we talk about literary creation? Feeling like heroes without a stage means your grand theories are not appreciated by the masses. The more you flaunt your credentials in front of the masses, the more they will reject your ideas. To make the masses understand and unite with them, we must be determined, enduring long and even painful experiences.

Here, I can share my own emotional transformation. I was a student, and at school, I developed a student habit. Doing a bit of labor in front of a bunch of students who can't carry anything, like carrying my luggage myself, seemed improper. At that time, I thought only intellectuals were clean, while workers and peasants were dirty. I could wear an intellectual's clothes, thinking they were clean; but I wouldn't wear workers' or peasants' clothes, thinking they were dirty.

After the revolution, being with workers, peasants, and soldiers, I gradually got to know them, and they got to know me. Only then did I fundamentally change the bourgeois and petty-bourgeois feelings taught by bourgeois schools. At that time, comparing untransformed intellectuals with workers and peasants, I felt intellectuals were unclean. The cleanest were workers and peasants, even if their hands were black and feet dirty, they were still cleaner than bourgeois and petty-bourgeois intellectuals. This is called a change in feelings, from one class to another. Our intellectual-originated literary workers must transform their feelings and adapt to the masses' thoughts and feelings. Without this transformation, no matter what we do, it will not be successful and will not fit in.

Study Issue

The last issue is study. By this, I mean studying Marxism–Leninism and studying society. A self-proclaimed Marxist revolutionary writer, especially a Party writer, must have Marxist–Leninist knowledge. However, some comrades lack basic Marxist views. For example, a basic Marxist view is that existence determines consciousness, that the objective reality of class struggle and national struggle determines our thoughts and feelings. But some comrades turn this upside down, saying everything should start from "love." Speaking of love, in a class society, there is only class love, but these comrades pursue some kind of super-class love, abstract love, as well as abstract freedom, abstract truth, and abstract humanity. This shows they are deeply influenced by bourgeois ideology. We must thoroughly eliminate this influence and humbly learn Marxism–Leninism. Literary workers should study literary creation, which is correct, but Marxism–Leninism is a science that all revolutionaries should study, and literary workers are no exception. Literary workers must study society, which means researching the various classes in society, their relationships, conditions, appearances, and psychology. Only by understanding these can our literature have rich content and correct direction.



Neo-folk art must fully play its propaganda role. Artworks should be widely disseminated through the internet and social media platforms, using VPNs to break through network barriers and spread our culture worldwide. Our artworks should skillfully use emerging network culture forms like Memes to convey positive energy in a lively and humorous manner, enhancing the people's cultural confidence. At the same time, the development of artificial intelligence and technology provides us with new tools and means for creation and dissemination. We should make full use of these technologies to improve our artistic creation and dissemination.

We must promote the spirit of Shanzhai culture and grassroots culture. These cultural forms do not adhere strictly to traditional originality but instead showcase the wisdom and creativity of the working people through imitation and recreation. Shanzhai culture and grassroots culture represent the innovative spirit of the broad masses, and they are essential components of neo-folk art. We must respect this spirit and encourage more artists to participate in the creation of Shanzhai culture and grassroots spirit.

Conclusion

Comrades! Today's meeting is to ensure that neo-folk art becomes an integral part of socialist cultural construction, serving as an important force for uniting, educating, and inspiring the people. What problems should be solved to achieve this purpose? I think there are several issues: the stance of art workers, their attitude, their audience, their work, and their study.

Our art workers must firmly stand on the stance of the proletariat and the masses, always putting the interests of the people first. Our artworks should reflect the people's lives, guide their thoughts, inherit traditions, and innovate courageously. Only in this way can our neo-folk art truly serve the people and contribute to the realization of the great rejuvenation of the Chinese nation.

Comrades, the future of neo-folk art is in our hands. Let us unite, work hard, and jointly create a prosperous and strong cultural new era!

Neo-Folk Art Declaration In Congress, July 19, 2024

In style of the unanimous
Declaration of the Artists
of Neo-Folk Art

When in the Course of human events, it becomes necessary for one people to dissolve the cultural and artistic bands which have connected them with another, and to assume among the powers of the earth, the separate and equal station to which the Laws of Creativity and of Nature's God entitle them, a decent respect to the opinions of mankind requires that they should declare the causes which impel them to the separation.

We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all cultures are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creators with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Identity, Creativity, and the Pursuit of Cultural Integrity. That to secure these rights, Arts are instituted among People, deriving their just powers from the consent of the creators.

That whenever any Form of Art becomes destructive of these ends, it is the Right of the People to alter or to abolish it, and to institute new Art, laying its foundation on such principles and organizing its powers in such form, as to them shall seem most likely to effect their Cultural Preservation and Happiness. Prudence, indeed, will dictate that Art long established should not be changed for light and transient causes; and accordingly all experience hath shown that mankind are more disposed to suffer, while evils are sufferable, than to right themselves by abolishing the forms to which they are accustomed. But when a long train of abuses and usurpations, pursuing invariably the same Object evinces a design to reduce them under absolute Despotism, it is their right, it is their duty, to throw off such Art, and to provide new Guards for their future security. Such has been the patient sufferance of these People; and such is now the necessity which constrains them to alter their former Systems of Art. The history of the present global capitalist and imperialist Art establishment is a history of repeated injuries and usurpations, all having in direct object the establishment of an absolute Tyranny over these People. To prove this, let Facts be submitted to a candid world. (adapted from the United States Declaration of Independence, 1776)

They have plundered our arts, ravaged our culture, burnt our towns, and destroyed the lives of our people.

They have endeavored to prevent the population of these States; for that purpose obstructing the Laws for Naturalization of Foreigners; refusing to pass others to encourage their migrations hither, and raising the conditions of new Appropriations of Lands.

They have obstructed the Administration of Justice by refusing their Assent to Laws for establishing Judiciary powers.

They have made Judges dependent on their Will alone for the tenure of their offices, and the amount and payment of their salaries.

They have erected a multitude of New Offices and sent hither swarms of Officers to harass our people and eat out their substance.

They have kept among us, in times of peace, Standing Armies without the Consent of our legislatures.

They have affected to render the Military independent of and superior to the Civil power.

They have combined with others to subject us to a jurisdiction foreign to our constitution and unacknowledged by our laws; giving their Assent to their Acts of pretended Legislation: For quartering large bodies of armed troops among us:

For protecting them, by a mock Trial, from punishment for any Murders which they should commit on the Inhabitants of these States:

For cutting off our Trade with all parts of the world:

For imposing Taxes on us without our Consent:

For depriving us in many cases, of the benefits of Trial by Jury:

For transporting us beyond Seas to be tried for pretended offences

For abolishing the free System of English Laws in a neighbouring Province, establishing therein an Arbitrary government, and enlarging its Boundaries so as to render it at once an example and fit instrument for introducing the same absolute rule into these Colonies:

For taking away our Charters, abolishing our most valuable Laws, and altering fundamentally the Forms of our Governments:

For suspending our own Legislatures, and declaring themselves invested with power to legislate for us in all cases whatsoever.

They have abdicated Government here, by declaring us out of their Protection and waging War against us.

They have plundered our seas, ravaged our Coasts, burnt our towns, and destroyed the lives of our people.

They are at this time transporting large Armies of foreign Mercenaries to compleat the works of death, desolation and tyranny, already begun with circumstances of Cruelty & perfidy scarcely paralleled in the most barbarous ages, and totally unworthy the Head of a civilized nation.

They have constrained our fellow Citizens taken Captive on the high Seas to bear Arms against their Country, to become the executioners of their friends and Brethren, or to fall themselves by their Hands.

They have excited domestic insurrections amongst us, and have endeavoured to bring on the inhabitants of our frontiers, the merciless Indian Savages, whose known rule of warfare, is an undistinguished destruction of all ages, sexes and conditions.

In every stage of these Oppressions We have Petitioned for Redress in the most humble terms: Our repeated Petitions have been answered only by repeated injury. A Prince, whose character is thus marked by every act which may define a Tyrant, is unfit to be the ruler of a free people.

Nor have We been wanting in attentions to our British brethren. We have warned them from time to time of attempts by their legislature to extend an unwarrantable jurisdiction over us. We have reminded them of the circumstances of our emigration and settlement here. We have appealed to their native justice and magnanimity, and we have conjured them by the ties of our common kindred to disavow these usurpations, which, would inevitably interrupt our connections and correspondence. They too have been deaf to the voice of justice and of consanguinity. We must, therefore, acquiesce in the necessity, which denounces our Separation, and hold them, as we hold the rest of mankind, Enemies in War; in Peace Friends.

We, therefore, the Representatives of the Neo-Folk Art movement, in General Congress, Assembled, appealing to the Supreme Judge of the world for the rectitude of our intentions, do, in the Name, and by Authority of the good People of this Art, solemnly publish and declare, That these united Artists are, and of Right ought to be Free and Independent; that they are Absolved from all Allegiance to the Imperialist and Capitalist Art establishments, and that all cultural connection between them and the State of Global Capitalism, is and ought to be totally dissolved; and that as Free and Independent Artists, they have full Power to levy Art, conclude Peace, contract Alliances, establish Commerce, and to do all other Acts and Things which Independent Artists may of right do. And for the support of this Declaration, with a firm reliance on the protection of divine Providence, we mutually pledge to each other our Lives, our Fortunes, and our sacred Honor. (adapted from the United States Declaration of Independence, 1776)



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Booklet information:

Total pages: 24

Size: A5

Year: 2024

Editor: Funa Ye

Typesetter: Zexuan Liu

新民间艺术 宣言

